Speaking Part 1: Education

Every answer: Answer + Reason + Example (2 to 4 sentences, about 20 seconds). Do not stop after one sentence, and do not give a speech.

Work or study

1 Do you work or are you a student?
2 What are you studying at the moment?
3 Why did you choose this subject?
4 What is the most difficult part of your studies?

School and teachers

5 Did you enjoy primary school?
6 Who was your favorite teacher, and why?
7 Do you think teachers today are stricter than in the past?
8 Would you like to be a teacher one day?

Learning

9 Do you prefer studying alone or with other people?
10 What is something new you have learned recently?
11 Do you use your phone for studying?
12 How do you usually prepare for an exam?

Good ways to start

To be honest, … · Actually, … · I'd say …, mainly because … · It depends. If …, then …, but … · For example, … · That's an interesting question. I've never really thought about it, but …

Model answers

Do you prefer studying alone or with other people?
Mostly alone, to be honest. I concentrate much better when it's quiet, so I usually study at home in the evening. That said, before a big exam I sometimes meet a friend, because explaining things to each other shows what we still don't understand.

Who was your favorite teacher, and why?
My English teacher in secondary school. She never just gave us the rules; she made us use the language in games and short debates. I think that's why I started enjoying English instead of being afraid of it.

What is something new you have learned recently?
I've recently learned how to plan an essay in five minutes. Before, I used to start writing straight away and got lost in the middle. Now I write my position and two reasons first, and my essays are much clearer.

Answer · reason · example. Notice the tenses: present simple for habits, present perfect for experience, past simple for finished time.

Grammar of the day: present tenses and modal verbs for opinions

Part 1 is about you now: your habits, your situation and your opinions. Three present tenses and a few modal verbs cover almost every answer.

FORM	USE IT FOR	EXAMPLES	SIGNAL WORDS
Present simple	habits, routines, facts, likes	*I usually study in the evening.* · *I don't enjoy math.*	always, usually, often, sometimes, rarely, never, every day
Present continuous	now, these days, temporary situations	*At the moment I'm preparing for IELTS.* · *I'm reading a lot these days.*	now, at the moment, currently, these days, this year
Present perfect	experience, and from the past until now	*I've studied English for six years.* · *I've never been to the UK.*	for, since, ever, never, already, recently, so far
Modal verbs for opinions	softer, more polite opinions and advice	*Teachers should give less homework.* · *It might be useful.* · *I'd say …*	should, ought to, might, could, would, can

Practice

Common mistakes

✗ I am study English for six years.	✓ I've studied (have been studying) English for six years.
✗ I am usually studying in the evening.	✓ I usually study in the evening.
✗ Teachers must to be patient.	✓ Teachers must be patient. (no 'to' after must, should, can, might)
✗ I am agree.	✓ I agree.

Fill in the gaps

1. Right now I ___ (prepare) for an important exam.
2. I ___ (study) at this university since 2024.
3. I ___ (usually / revise) on Sunday mornings.
4. I ___ (never / have) a teacher who shouted at us.
5. In my opinion, schools ___ teach more practical skills. (advice)
6. Online classes ___ be useful for shy students. (possibility)
7. These days more students ___ (use) AI to check their essays.
8. Most of my friends ___ (prefer) studying in groups.

Say it

- Answer three questions above with a present perfect sentence (for / since / never).
- Answer 'Do you think teachers today are stricter than in the past?' with should or might.

Answers

1. am preparing
2. have studied / have been studying
3. usually revise
4. have never had
5. should
6. might / could
7. are using
8. prefer (a state verb: no -ing)